

MAY-JUNE 2026 · PERFORMANCE & PULSE

Recovery, and a month that held its *line*.

For the period 1 May to 14 June 2026

929

MAY DOWNLOADS
FIRST CLEAN FULL MONTH

+31%

VS PRE-HWL
BASELINE

5 / 5

NEW EPISODES
OVER 100 DOWNLOADS

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Pulse.

April raised one worry above all others: Spotify had broken its floor. **May answered it.** Plays are up 29%, consumption hours up 28%, and the platform-specific drop has reversed.

At the same time the show recorded its first clean full month on Acast at 929 downloads, and it held that number while running a week short on episodes. This was a strong month that also closed the open question from the last one.

The honest read up front: the recovery is real and broad, but two things April flagged are still open. Spotify follower growth stayed slow even as plays recovered, and the show missed an episode the week of 4 June. Neither dented the month. Both are worth protecting against.

+29%

Spotify plays vs April (216 → 279). The April floor was transient.

1,184

views on the breakout YouTube short, "Your Office is Lying to You??", at 14.7% CTR.

+134

LinkedIn followers on Cathal's profile, to 4,070.

A NOTE ON METRICS

Spotify changed its definition of a "play" on 11 June 2026, moving to a 30-second standard. Every Spotify figure here sits before that change, so May is a clean like-for-like against April. From next month, plays are counted differently, and we will flag the discontinuity so the trend is not misread.

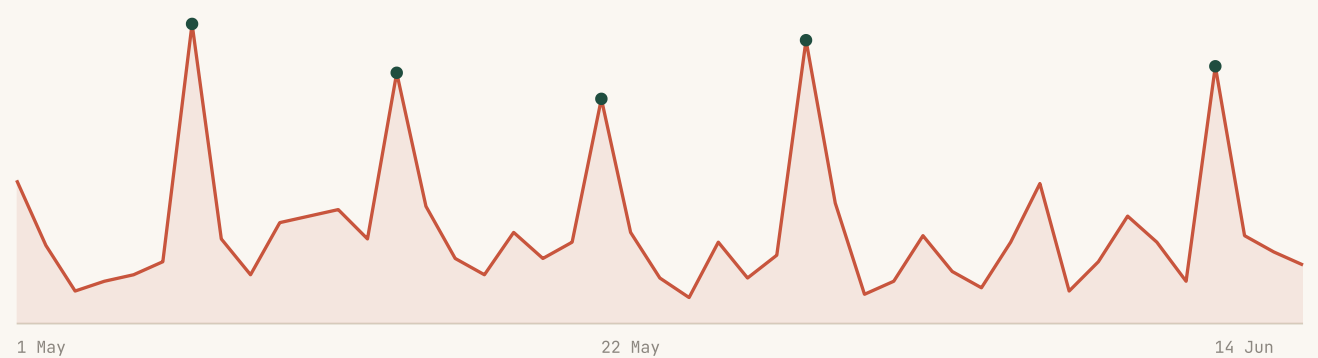
THE HEADLINE DATA · ACAST

A full month, *in full.*

Total downloads across the 45 days were **1,297**. May on its own, the first complete calendar month on Acast, landed at **929**. That is **+31% on the pre-HWL Omny baseline** of 710 a month, and the first time we can compare a whole month like-for-like since the migration. April's 869 over 23 days extrapolated to a headline of ~1,133. May is the real thing, measured end to end.

710 PRE-HWL BASELINE Avg/mo · Omny · Nov 24–Aug 25	869 APRIL (PART MONTH) Acast · 23 days · Apr 8–30	929 +31% MAY 2026 · FULL MONTH Acast · vs baseline
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DAILY DOWNLOADS · 1 MAY – 14 JUNE · THE WEEKLY LAUNCH PULSE



Launch days marked. Spikes of 69–92 on drop day, an 11–44 back-catalogue baseline every other day. A healthy long tail.

EPISODE PERFORMANCE

Every episode *landed*.

Every new episode cleared 100 downloads in its window. That is the month-on-month signal: not one breakout, but a floor that holds across the slate.

EPISODE	DROP	ACAST DOWNLOADS
The 3 Things Every Office Steals From You · Leidy Klotz Top of period	28 May	179
Why Smart Leaders Stop Making Clear Choices · Wendy Smith	14 May	165
Pet Shop Rabbits, Hope, and Big Career Moves · Q&A with Annette	7 May	153
Why Doing Everything Means You Finish Nothing · Listener Questions	21 May	135
We Can't Yoga Our Way Out of Bad Culture · Jennifer Moss Carry-over from 30 Apr	30 Apr	106
Why Your Office Feels Wrong · Listener Questions 3 days in, pacing	11 Jun	105

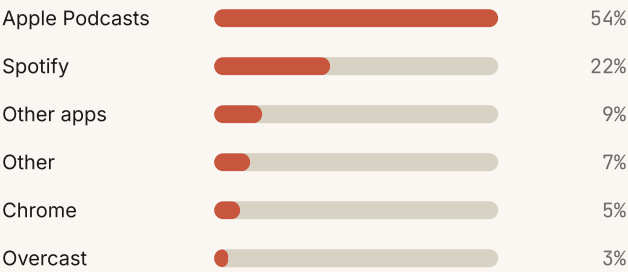
LAUNCH-DAY DOWNLOADS

Q&A Annette · 7 May		92
Leidy Klotz · 28 May		87
LQ Office · 11 Jun		79
Wendy Smith · 14 May		77
LQ Finish · 21 May		69

AUDIENCE & DISTRIBUTION

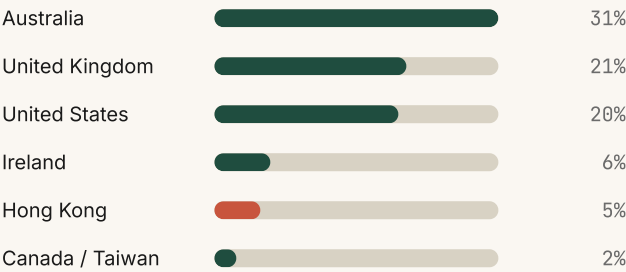
Where people *listen*.

PLATFORM · SHARE OF 1,297



Apple still carries the show. Spotify's share rose from 19% in April to 22%, the download-side echo of the Spotify recovery overleaf.

GEOGRAPHY · SHARE OF 1,297



The UK keeps closing on Australia. **France**, April's bright spot at 6%, fell under 1%, the one-off we suspected. **Hong Kong** (5%) and **Taiwan** (2%) emerged in its place. Worth watching whether they hold.

THE TURNAROUND

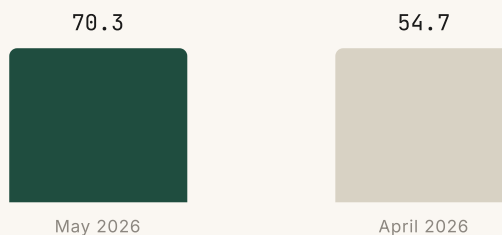
The floor *came back*.

April's loudest signal was a Spotify-specific drop: 216 plays, below the Season 4 floor. May reversed it. Plays are up 29% and back above the December floor of 249, tracking toward the Season 4 average. Consumption hours rose 28% in step.

PLAYS · MAY VS APRIL VS S4 AVERAGE



CONSUMPTION HOURS · MAY VS APRIL



THE APRIL DATA GAP IS CLOSED

We can now see Spotify show-page impressions: roughly **2,632** over the 30 days Spotify retains. New episodes surface through the Home feed (Leidy Klotz 185, 139 from Home); the back catalogue earns impressions through Search (Tasha Eurich 72, 59 from Search). The integration is working as it should post-migration.

ONE HONEST CAVEAT

Plays recovered. **Followers did not.** Net new followers held at +4, the same slow rate April flagged, against a typical +7 to +12. People are listening more, but not subscribing at the same pace. It is the clearest single thing to fix on Spotify, and the plan carries an action.

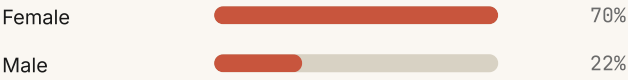
AUDIENCE

For the first time, *we can see the room.*

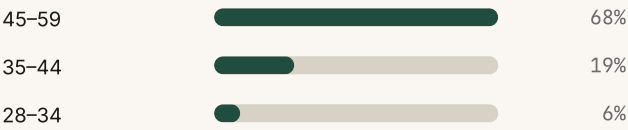
The migration and the LinkedIn analytics together give us an audience picture we did not have in April. Two surfaces, two complementary readings.

On Spotify, the core is clear.

GENDER



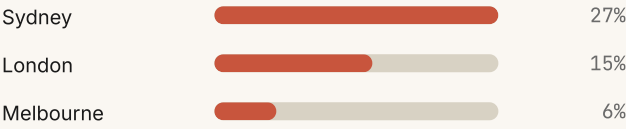
AGE



The centre of the audience is **women aged 45 to 59**. A precise, usable profile for guest selection and any sponsor conversation. Spotify subset, so directional rather than the whole audience.

On LinkedIn, senior and professional.

LOCATION



SENIORITY & SECTOR

Around **60% are Senior, Director or CXO** level. They work in **Financial Services (17%), Consulting (9%) and Banking (9%)**, at firms like Westpac, Laing O'Rourke and Goldman Sachs.

This mirrors the podcast geography and gives the brand a credible B2B audience to point at.

YOUTUBE · LINKEDIN · INSTAGRAM

Three channels, *three jobs*.

YouTube, compounding.

2,338 VIEWS April 2,140	65.6 WATCH HOURS April 33.8 · ~2×	+10 SUBSCRIBERS April +5 · ~2×
6,068 IMPRESSIONS April 4,729	3.18% CLICK-THROUGH RATE April 2.41%	1,184 BREAKOUT SHORT "Office is Lying" · 14.7% CTR

Watch hours and subscribers both roughly doubled. The shorts engine found another breakout, the highest since "Prisoners are happier". Long-form does the deep work (Jennifer Moss 16.3 hrs). Shorts win reach, longs win retention. Subscriber conversion is the gap to close.

LinkedIn, the proof of work.

21.9k IMPRESSIONS 8,167 reached	+134 FOLLOWERS · TO 4,070 +103 in May
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665 engagements at ~3%. Top by reach: the 7 May episode push (5,203). Top by engagement: the 5 June season wrap-up (114). And **the newsletter is back**. The 2 June post relaunched The Better Bits, closing an April open item.

Instagram, early.

9,433 VIEWS 1,628 reached	+17 NET FOLLOWERS 409 interactions
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Consistent but small. **73.5% of views came from existing followers** and bio-link taps numbered 4. Instagram is serving the base, not finding new people or sending traffic. A discovery lever to test, not a number to lean on yet.

THE HONEST READ

What's working. *What needs work.*

WORKING**The Spotify recovery.**

Plays +29%, consumption +28%. April's worry is answered.

A clean full month on Acast.

929 downloads, +31% on baseline, held while a week short on episodes. Resilience, not luck.

Every episode landed.

All five new releases cleared 100; Leidy Klotz (179) and Wendy Smith (165) led.

YouTube is compounding.

Watch hours and subs doubled, and the shorts engine found another breakout.

The newsletter is back.

The Better Bits relaunched on 2 June.

We can see the audience.

Women 45–59 on the podcast, senior finance on LinkedIn.

NEEDS WORK**Spotify follower velocity.**

Plays recovered, follower growth did not (+4, against a +7 to +12 norm). Fix: a clear follow prompt in the outro and show notes.

Cadence.

The week of 4 June had no episode. It cost nothing this month, but do not test it twice. Protect the weekly drop.

Instagram discovery.

Active but inward-facing (73.5% of views from followers, 4 bio-link taps). One reach lever to trial, likely Reels.

YouTube subscriber conversion.

View volume is not yet turning into subscribers at pace. Add an explicit subscribe ask to the shorts that travel.

JUNE-JULY

The plan.

- 01 Roger Martin, recorded 12 June, is the next tentpole.** Treat the launch as one coordinated day: Acast, YouTube long plus shorts, clips, LinkedIn and the newsletter on the same date.
- 02 Hold the weekly cadence.** No more skipped weeks through the season close.
- 03 Newsletter.** Hold the relaunched cadence and add the signup CTA to every episode description and Cathal's LinkedIn bio.
- 04 Spotify follow prompt.** Ship the outro and show-note follow ask this month and read the follower line next report.
- 05 YouTube subscribe ask** on the shorts that break out, and use the women 45–59 / senior-finance read to guide guest choices.